

PROJECT REPORT:

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Introduction :

This project was created under the scenario of a student digital ambassador as a part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal. The primary objective of this project was to create a digital portfolio that showcased knowledge of different modern technical and communication domains. In today's digital age, where being digital means being professional, this project has been created around five major domains of visual information design, professional networking, technical practice, communication etiquette, and cybersecurity awareness. Through this project, I have created a repository of resources that aim to educate fellow students on how to safely and professionally use the internet. In this report, I shall highlight the tools that were used to create this project and the learning outcomes that were achieved during the entire semester-long ambassador program.

Task1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool used: Canva

For the first module of this project, I stepped into my role as a Student Digital Ambassador by creating a one-page infographic titled "Building Digital Literacy: A Student Guide". I used Canva to design a clean, four-quadrant layout that covers the essential pillars of the course: a foundational definition of digital literacy, key tools for student success (such as GitHub and LinkedIn), safe internet practices, and professional email etiquette.

The design utilizes a mix of concise bullet points and recognizable icons, like the Google Workspace and LinkedIn logos, to ensure the information is accessible and easy for my batchmates to scan at a glance. One thing I found particularly interesting during this process was the challenge of distilling complex security advice, such as Two-Factor Authentication(2FA), into a single, a balanced between technical accuracy and visual simplicity. Ensuring that the layout remained professional yet engaging was a rewarding exercise in modern technical communication.

Task2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

Platform set up: LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle

For the second task of this project, I focused on establishing a professional digital presence by setting up foundational profiles on **LinkedIn**, **GitHub**, and **Kaggle**. On GitHub, I created a specialized **Profile README** repository, which serves as a digital introduction to my technical interests and academic background. This repository includes my name, branch, and a specific goal for my four-year engineering journey. On LinkedIn, I updated my education section to reflect my current degree at **VIT Bhopal**

University, ensuring that my academic progress is visible to potential internship coordinators.

I chose these platforms because they represent the essential trio of modern professional development: networking, version control, and data science practice. Over the next four years, I plan to use **GitHub** to document my coding projects, **LinkedIn** to connect with industry mentors, and **Kaggle** to refine my analytical skills through global competitions. Building this portfolio early allows me to transition from a student to a professional with a verifiable track record of my skills and growth. This task taught me that a well-maintained digital identity is a vital tool for career transparency and collaboration.

Task 3: Coding platforms

For task 3, I explored technical and collaboration platforms by completing a coding challenge on **HackerRank** and developing a cloud-based assessment tool using **Google Forms**. I successfully solved the ‘Solve Me First’ challenge, which reinforced my understanding of basic input-output logic and competitive programming environments.

Additionally, I created a five-question ‘Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz’ to educate my peers on topics like two-factor authentication and professional networking. I linked this form to a **Google Sheet** to automate response tracking, demonstrating how cloud tools can streamline data collection and collaboration. Academically, these platforms are invaluable; coding practice tools help me prepare for technical interviews and improve problem-solving speed, while Google Workspace tools are essential for managing group projects and sharing research data efficiently. This task highlighted the importance of using diverse digital platforms to both practice individual skills and facilitate group-wide literacy.

Task 4: Reflection on Communication

Effective digital communication is a cornerstone of professional success. For task 4, I practiced this by drafting formal emails to a professor and an internship coordinator, focusing on maintaining a respectful tone and clear structure. I also developed a social media guide to help my peers navigate online spaces responsibly.

A common communication pitfall occurs when students use informal ‘text-speak’ in professional emails, which can lead to misunderstanding or a lack of credibility. For example, a student might send a deadline request without a subject line or clear context, causing delays in the professor’s response. To avoid this, I have learned the importance of using descriptive subject lines and formal salutations. This task reinforced that clarity and etiquette are not just about politeness, but about ensuring our professional needs are met efficiently.

Task 5: Cybercrime Report

While researching UPI fraud, I was most surprised to learn how easily scammers use 'social engineering' to manipulate victims into scanning QR codes. It is alarming that the very tools designed for convenience can be turned into weapons by simply mispresenting a 'Send' request as a 'Receive' voucher .

As a result of this research, I will personally change my habit of scanning QR codes for any promotional or refund-related claims without first verifying the source. I have also enabled two-factor authentication on all my financial apps and will now double-check the recipient's name displayed on the UPI interface before every transaction.

Understanding the step-by-step mechanics of these frauds has made me much more cautious about my digital footprint and financial safety.

Conclusion:

This project has been a life-changing experience in terms of the various facets of digital literacy. It is not only about working with software but also the need for effective communication and security measures. Integrating my technical profiles on GitHub and LinkedIn has given me a solid platform to look to for the future, and the investigation into cybercrime has made me a savvier user of digital financial services. Overall, this project has reminded me of the need for a Student Digital Ambassador to be knowledgeable of both technical and moral aspects of digital literacy in order to make a positive contribution to the digital community during my four-year engineering journey .